

# BARAKA TINEYI HOMODZA

Game Programmer · Unreal Engine 5 & Unity

Harare, Zimbabwe · UTC+2 · Open to remote & relocation

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## SUMMARY

Game programmer working in Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & Blueprints) and Unity (C#) across gameplay systems, enemy AI, and editor tooling. Commissioned solo developer of Chengetedzo, a financial-literacy simulation built for Aubik Business Solutions and released in July 2026. Led and onboarded a cohort of 12 programming interns at Nimbus Games (Kuala Lumpur).

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**Nimbus Games | Tech Intern** Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia · Jul–Nov 2024

- Programmed puzzle systems, gameplay mechanics, and NPC behaviour in Unreal Engine 5 for an unannounced title (under NDA).
- Selected to lead a cohort of 12 incoming programming interns for the final 2.5 months: onboarded them in UE5 and guided design, planning, and development of an initial game prototype under the studio's Chief Creative Director.
- Playtested and gave QA feedback on studio titles Parasomnia and Anachron.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

**Chengetedzo | Financial Literacy Simulation (Unity, C#)** Jan–Jul 2026 · released July 2026

*Solo Programmer & Designer · art commissioned from Bill Masuku*

- Commissioned by Aubik Business Solutions and released July 2026: a mobile simulation of Zimbabwean household finance.
- Built a 24-month simulation with 3 playable profiles, 100+ weighted events with seasonal filters and event chains, 8 insurance types with waiting periods and deductibles, and loan/savings systems.
- Implemented JSON save persistence, a financial-momentum scoring system, contextual mentor guidance, and a headless simulation mode for automated stress-testing.

[github.com/bababuyi/Chengetedzo](https://github.com/bababuyi/Chengetedzo) · [babazw.itch.io/chengetedzo](https://babazw.itch.io/chengetedzo)

**Two Weak Notice | Office-Chair Combat Game (Unreal Engine 5, Blueprints)** 7-day jam · Jun 2026 · released

*Gameplay Programmer (all gameplay) · Serious Game Jam · art by Nate & Shephard, UI by Kekouh*

- Replaced CharacterMovementComponent with hand-integrated velocity, spin and drag each tick, using swept movement for collision and wall kicks that reflect into speed boosts.
- One enemy base class drives four enemy types purely through data on class defaults; a single global Heat value gates every enemy's aggro, so speed is both damage output and threat.
- Built an Editor Utility Widget that converts level props into kickable physics actors in two clicks.

[github.com/bababuyi/TwoWeakNotice](https://github.com/bababuyi/TwoWeakNotice) · [babazw.itch.io/two-weak-notice](https://babazw.itch.io/two-weak-notice)

**Late For My Own Show | Ragdoll Physics Game (Unreal Engine 5.6, Blueprints)** 7-day jam · Sep 2026 · released

*Solo: design and programming · Free Lives' Physics Jam 2026 (unofficial entry)*

- Built a crowd of ~4,000 independent hand actors, each applying a pose- and zone-scaled impulse on overlap; the ride emerges from local pushes with no central controller.
- Data-driven crowd zones (struct presets selected by enum) override hand behaviour and drive stage lighting; one Game Mode state machine owns the timer, win/lose and a single shared restart path.
- Shipped a packaged Windows build, diagnosing a Shipping-only ray tracing crash that never appeared in PIE.

[github.com/bababuyi/LateForMyOwnShow](https://github.com/bababuyi/LateForMyOwnShow) · [babazw.itch.io/late-for-my-own-show](https://babazw.itch.io/late-for-my-own-show)

**Reflection of the Mind | Narrative Puzzle Game (Unreal Engine 5.5)** Mar–Jul 2025 · C++ rework in progress

*Solo Developer: programming, design, narrative, art (final-year project)*

- Fully playable vertical slice (Chapter 1, three acts) of a psychological therapy game.
- Built a data-driven branching dialogue system on DataTables with per-choice trust deltas; persistent trust state branches the narrative per act.
- Created five reusable UMG puzzle widgets triggered directly from dialogue rows.
- Currently migrating systems from Widget Blueprints to C++ with Blueprints.

[github.com/bababuyi/Reflection-Of-The-Mind](https://github.com/bababuyi/Reflection-Of-The-Mind)

## CatBurglar | Stealth AI Prototype (Unity) Apr–May 2026

Solo AI Programmer & Designer

- Built two interacting FSM agents: an 8-state grandma AI whose window-closing routine doubles as the level timer, and a 7-state dog AI with pinning, carrying, and bark-based alerts that escalate to the grandma.

[github.com/bababuyi/CatBurglar](https://github.com/bababuyi/CatBurglar)

## Side Step | Mobile Endless Runner (Unity) Team project Jan–Mar 2025 · solo rework Jun–Jul 2026

v1: procedural generation & 3D art · rework: all systems, solo

- Original team project: implemented procedural tile and wall spawning and modelled obstacles and environment assets.
- Solo rework (complete): rewrote nearly all systems: event-driven managers, adaptive difficulty with anti-frustration pacing, four power-ups with a 10-level upgrade shop, a two-stage health model, and persistent progression; remodelled assets and added new environment props in Blender; refined a teammate's curved-world shader.

[github.com/bababuyi/EtiqaEndlessRunner](https://github.com/bababuyi/EtiqaEndlessRunner) · [babazw.itch.io/side-step](https://babazw.itch.io/side-step)

## Unity Scene Auditor | Editor Tool (C#) Feb 2026 – present

Tools Programmer

- Editor extension that exports scene hierarchies, transforms, components, and public script variables to text; built during Chengetedzo to debug reference errors and diff scenes, now used across projects.

[github.com/bababuyi/UnitySceneAuditor](https://github.com/bababuyi/UnitySceneAuditor)

## EDUCATION

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### BSc (Hons) Computer Games Development Graduated April 2026

Dual award: Asia Pacific University (Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia) & De Montfort University (UK)

Second Class Upper Honours · CGPA 3.29 / 4.0

## SKILLS

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**Programming Languages:** C++, C#, Python

**Engines:** Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & Blueprints), Unity

**Gameplay & Systems:** Enemy AI & finite state machines, branching dialogue, puzzle mechanics, procedural generation, simulation & economy systems, save/persistence

**Specialisations:** UI systems (UMG & Unity UI), editor tooling, data-driven design (DataTables, ScriptableObjects), mobile development, hard-surface 3D modelling (Blender)

**Tools:** Git / GitHub, Perforce, Blender

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

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- Panelist, Button Bash Game Development Conference (March 2026).
- Exchange student, Rotary E-Club District 9210, Brazil (2019–2020).
- Volunteer audio engineer, River of Life Church: live sound & media (2016–2022, 2026–present).

## LANGUAGES

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English (fluent) · Shona (fluent) · Brazilian Portuguese (fluent) · Spanish (basic)

## REFERENCES

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Available on request.